

Track your Followers

Initially you may have started following people right away so as to get a feel of Twitter, since the only way to join a conversation was to follow one first. But slowly if you see a need to streamline the list of people you follow, tools like Twitter Grader and Tweetcloud are at your service. Twitter Grader gives a grade from 1 to 100 to every user you run through its system, thus allowing you to investigate how engaged the people you follow are. Twinfluence is another useful tool with a more scientific approach to help you figure out who you wish to follow. Tweetcloud actually creates a tag cloud of a person's tweets to give a bird's eye view of the type of things they tweet about helping you see the content at a glance and decide better.

Figure out your Friends

Unlike other social networking sites Twitter allows you to follow most people without their permission and at times it helps to know which of the numerous names you follow actually follow you back and are more like friends rather than followers. Try Twitter Karma, a great app that lets you sort through all those you follow and see who are the ones you have a mutual follow/follow-back relationship with. Slightly easier in presentation for sorting through larger number of people is Friend or Follow. For those of you with relatively evolved Twitter presence, it might even be a good idea to sign up for an alternative service like Twitterless that also notifies you when you lose a follower. With almost 80% of Twitter users having less than 10 total tweets, it might be required to weed out the inactive ones regularly. For this you can use

Nest.Unclutterer or Twitoria, which block users who are following more than a certain number of people or who have been inactive for a certain number of days.

Using URL Shorteners

With that 140 character limit, a handy URL shortener will prove to be one of your most needed services in Twitter world. Initially Twitter was built-in with TinyURL, later replaced by bit.ly. If you use a dedicated Twitter client this job will be taken care of more easily. Like on TweetDeck, enable "Autoshorten URLs" in the update window and TweetDeck will automatically shorten any URLs that you type or paste into the update box. To make the shortened versions more recognizable, like TweetDeck, you too can use the youtube.be shortener for Youtube videos and flic.kr for Flickr links. Bit.ly does a fine job keeping track of clicks, however platforms like su.pr (stumble upon) will also keep other helpful data, like best time of day to send out links.

Between your Blog and Twitter

For the crowds more active in cyber space, linking your

Try Twitterfeed to feed your blog into Twitter, provide the URL of a blog's RSS feed and how often you want posts to Twitter, and Twitterfeed takes care of the rest. Also, next time instead of having to manually update your Facebook with your blog posts, you can let Twitterfeed handle it (without even using a Twitter account). If you are a Feedburner user, go to the Publicize tab in your account, then go to Socialize>Add Twitter Account, and now you are ready to post content on your Twitter account with the blog post's title and link. You can try things the other way round too, use Twitter Badges to post your Twitter updates on your blog. Just log into Twitter via the Twitter Badges webpage and pick the type of blog you use and follow simple instructions to finish the Twitter blog widget. Word of caution, remember to take a backup of all your content before you modify your blog's theme or layout or add another widget, as there may

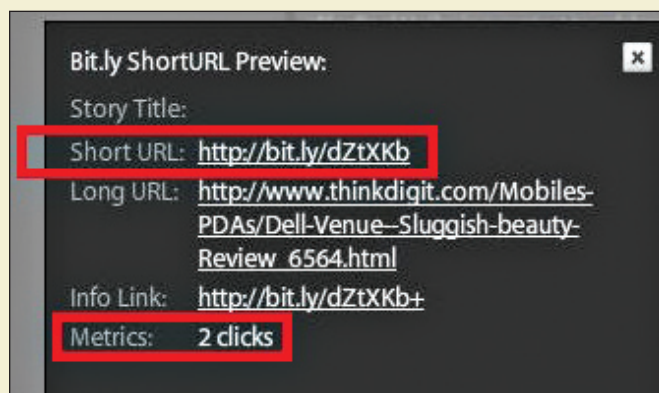


Adding a few plug-ins would transform your Twitter experience

provides two-way communication between your Twitter account and blog. To further simplify matters, try using a tool like dlvr.it, which automatically feeds your blog to Twitter, Facebook, Google Buzz and others, whole providing your with real time stats on your links, followers, friends and re-tweets.

Managing Multiple Accounts

With more and more people using Twitter for personal and professional reasons, the demand for a Twitter client to match these multifaceted needs is on the rise. Popular choices include TweetDeck, Seesmic(with no limits on the number of accounts you want to add), DestroyTwitter etc which are free and can be used from your desktop, phone, or on the web. As browser addons, try Echofon (formerly Twitterfox), a Firefox extension where you can toggle through multiple accounts in column view, ChromeBird, for Google Chrome, or Adjix2Twitter-Link, a bookmarklet by adjix that simply allows you to tweet links while browsing the web, but since you can specify which account to tweet from each time, this can be extremely handy at times. 



Use URL shorteners to save on characters

blog with your twitter account can help promote your blog as well as be a huge help in saving time and hassle.

be a few problems in store. If your blog is on Word Press, use Twitter Tools, a plug in for Word Press blogs that